Week 7: Strings Cheat Sheet

Normalising case

lower(), upper(), title() return new strings; e.g. " SRV-01 ".strip().lower() becomes "srv-01".

Removing whitespace

strip() removes leading/trailing whitespace; lstrip() removes left; rstrip() removes right. strip("*/") removes those characters at the edges.

Finding text

"error" in line.lower() tests case-insensitively. line.find("disk") gives a zero-based index or -1. line.count("ERROR") counts occurrences.

Replacing and matching

line.replace("_", "-") returns updated text. startswith("ERROR") and endswith(".log") filter records.

Split and join

"a b".split() handles repeated whitespace. "host,used=87".split(",", 1) limits splitting. " | ".join(["a", "b"]) builds "a | b".

Parsing records

Clean first, split fields, split each key=value once, convert numeric values, and store in a dictionary. Use try/except ValueError for bad numeric inputs.

Formatting

f"{name}: {used / total * 100:.1f}%" formats one decimal place. Convert numbers before joining: ",".join(str(n) for n in numbers).

Common errors

ValueError: too many values to unpack means too many pieces; use maxsplit=1. ValueError converting float means invalid numeric text. AttributeError means a method was called on an unsuitable type.